

# ART & CULTURE



## INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

**MODULE - 22**

**ARCHITECTURE OF  
DELHI SULTANATE**

## ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD



*Quwwat-ul-Islam built by Qutb-ud-din  
Aibak, founder of the Slave dynasty*

During the period of Delhi Sultanate, i.e. 1206-1526 A.D., architecture can be categorised into two broad categories:

- I. **Imperial Style:** Patronised by the rulers of the Delhi
- II. **Provincial Style:** Patronised by local rulers and fiefs.



A photograph of the Qutub Minar and the Qutub Mosque in Delhi, India. The minaret is a tall, tapering brick tower with multiple balconies and arched windows, rising from a base of yellow sandstone. The mosque to its left features a large, rounded dome and arched entrances. The sky is a clear, vibrant blue with some wispy clouds. The overall scene is bathed in the warm, golden light of late afternoon or early morning.

# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

IMPERIAL STYLE

1

SLAVE DYNASTY



# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## IMPERIAL STYLE

This is the style which was patronised by rulers of Delhi. Each ruler imparted certain flavours of his own, but the broad stylisation remained the same.

1

### SLAVE DYNASTY



*Quwwat-ul-Islam built by Qutb-ud-din  
Aibak, founder of the Slave dynasty*

1

The Slave dynasty remained in power from 1206 to 1290A.D. during that period, the style of architecture came to be known as the Mameluk style of architecture.

2

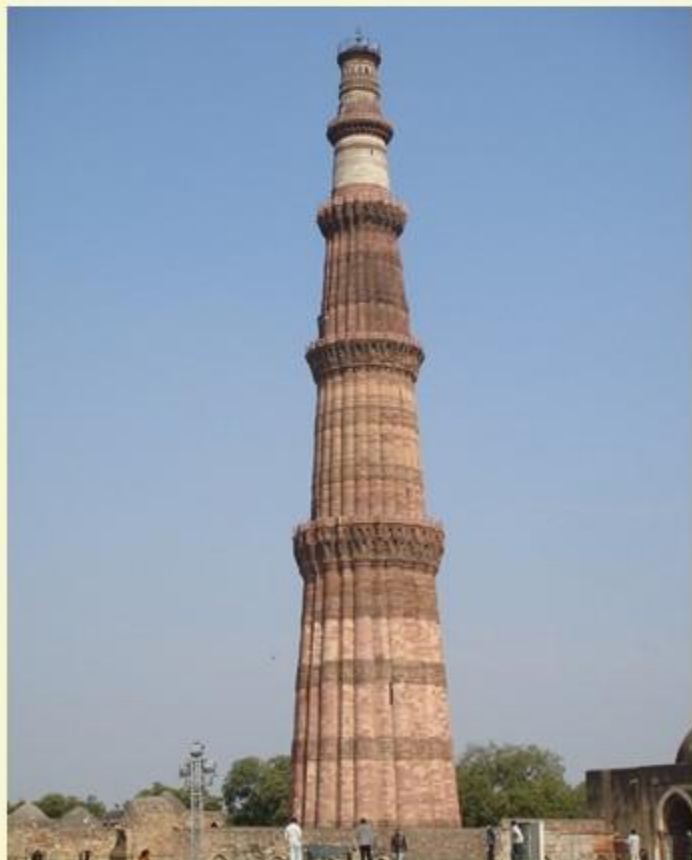
During this period, most of the constructions were **remodelling of the existing Hindu structures**. They also started the erection of a number of monuments, Qutub Minar being a prime example.

# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## IMPERIAL STYLE

1

SLAVE DYNASTY



**QUTUB MINAR**

2

It is a 5-storey structure initiated by Qutub-ud-din Aibak, who did only the ground floor. The next three storeys were completed by Iltutmish and the 5<sup>th</sup> storey was done by Feroze Shah Tughlaq.

**Example:** Quwat-ul-Islam mosque in the Qutub Minar Premises, which was converted from a Jain temple, Arhai-din-ka-Jhopra, etc.

2

The first three storeys are made of red sandstone; the fourth and fifth storeys are of marble and sandstone. At the foot of the tower are some of the notable structures like Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque, Alai Darwaza etc.



# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

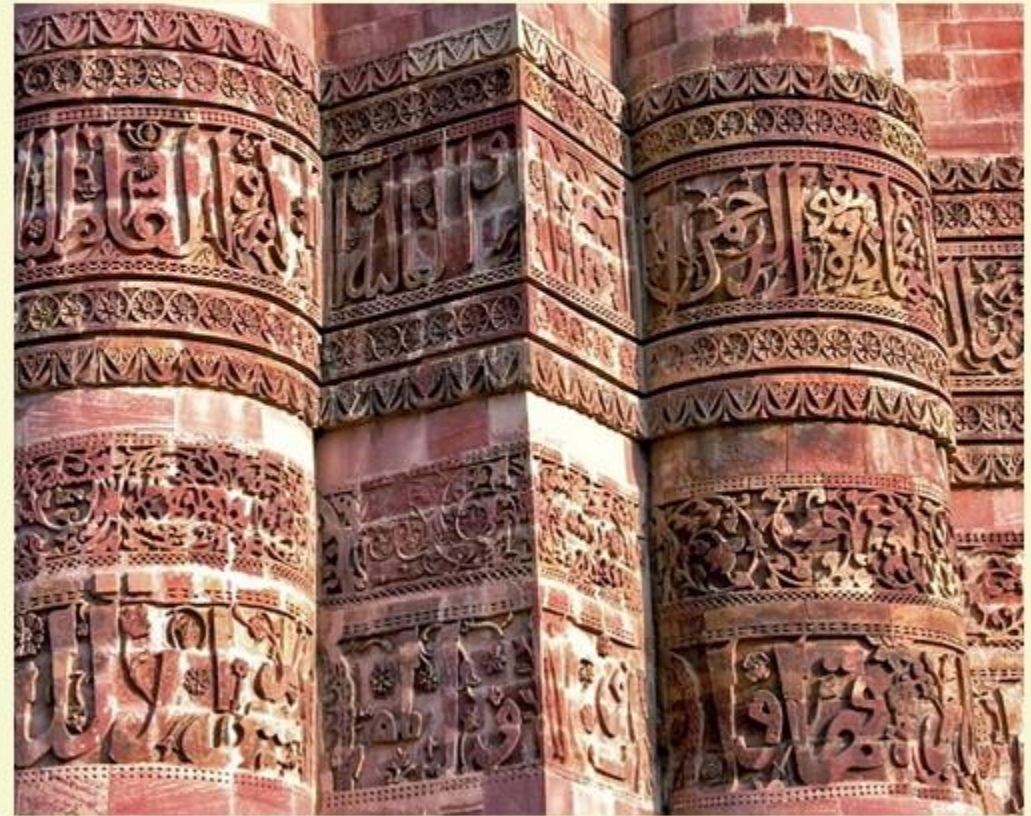
## IMPERIAL STYLE

1

SLAVE DYNASTY



*Projecting balconies of Qutb Minar*



*Calligraphic inscriptions in Qutb Minar*



# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## IMPERIAL STYLE

2

### KHILJI DYNASTY



**ALAI DARWAZA**

**1** They ruled from 1290 A.D. to 1320 A.D. and established the Seljuk style of architecture .

**2** The constructions of this period are marked by the use of **red sandstone**.

**3** Also, **the prominence of Arcuade style** began from this period.

**4** **Mortar** began to be used prominently in all the constructions as a cementing agent.  
**Example:** Alai Darwaza by Ala-ud-din Khilji, Siri fort, etc.

# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## IMPERIAL STYLE

3

### TUGHLAQ DYNASTY



OLD CITY OF TUGHLAQABAD

- 1 It was the **crisis period for architecture** during the Delhi Sultanate period.
- 2 However, some construction works were still undertaken, which used **grey sandstone**.
- 3 During this period, the focus was more on **strength of the building and so, there was less emphasis on decoration.**

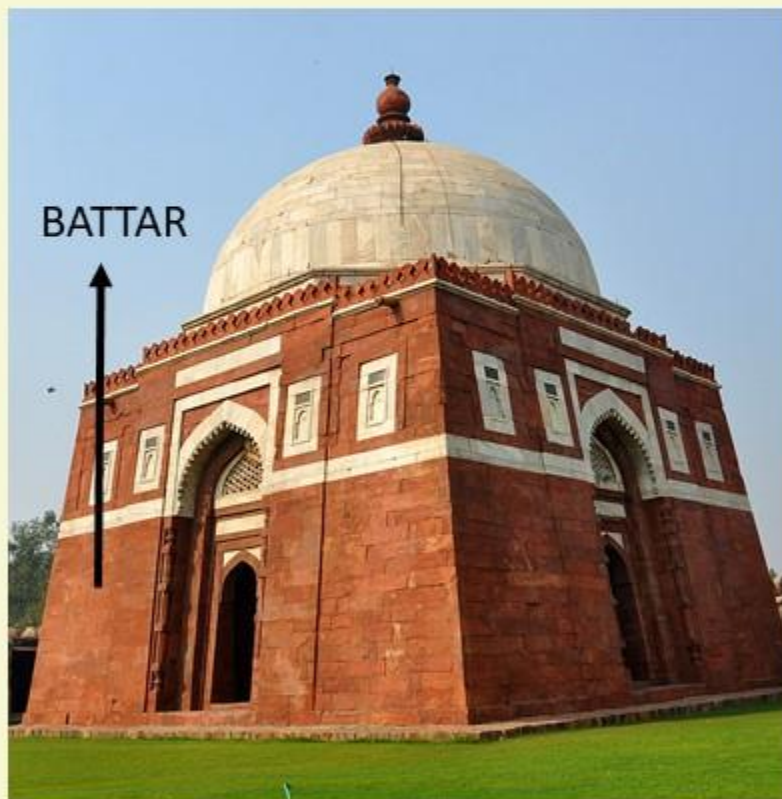


# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## IMPERIAL STYLE

3

### TUGHLAQ DYNASTY



**TOMB OF  
GHIYASUDDIN TUGHLAQ**

**4** The constructions combined both arch and lintel method of entrance design.

**5** They also introduced a style of construction known as 'battar' which was characterised by sloping walls to give more strength to the building.  
Example: Cities of Tughlaqabad, Jahaanpanah and Ferozabad.

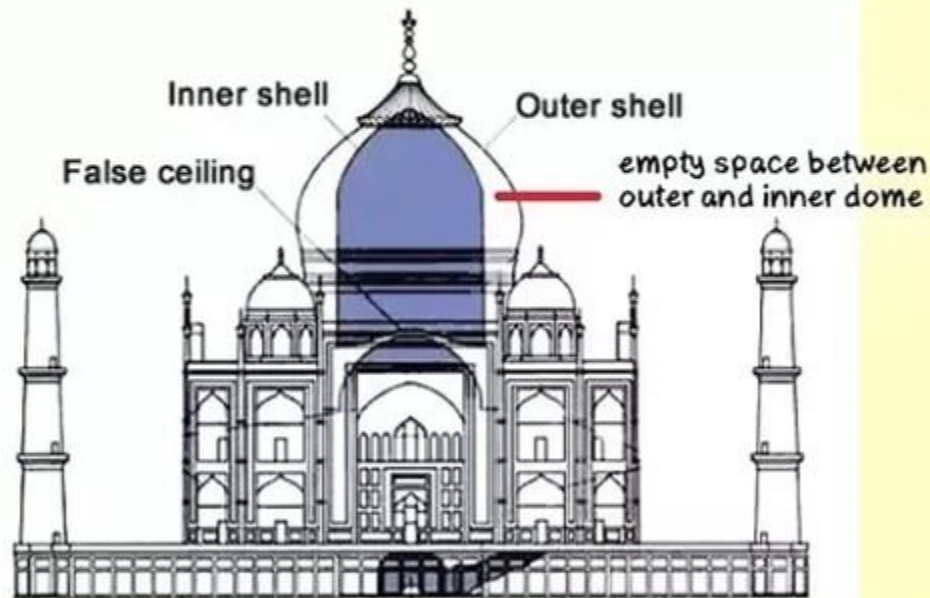


# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## IMPERIAL STYLE

4

LODI DYNASTY



**DOUBLE DOME STRUCTURE**

- 1 Under the Lodi dynasty, **architecture continued to take a back seat.**
- 2 **Only tombs** were commissioned during this period.
- 3 However, one important feature of architecture during this period was the **introduction of double domes.**
- 4 It consisted of a hallow dome inside the top dome.



# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## IMPERIAL STYLE

4

LODI DYNASTY



**LODI GARDENS**

5

The reasons for the use of double domes were:

- To give **strength to the structure**, and
- To **lower the inner height of the dome**.

6

The tombs built during this phase were hard and bare, without any lavish decorations.

7

They were built in **octagonal shapes**, with a diameter of roughly 15 meters. They were supported by a sloping verandah.

**Example:** Lodi gardens, the city of Agra was established by Sikandar Lodi, etc.



# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

During this period, the Indo-Islamic style started to influence the local architectural styles as well. Bengal, Bijapur, Jaunpur and Mandu became important seats of architectural development.

1

### BENGAL SCHOOL



1

The Bengal school of architecture was characterised in its use of bricks and black marble.

2

The mosques built during this period continued the use of sloping 'Bangla roofs', which was previously used for temples. Examples: Qadam Rasul mosque in Gaur, Adina mosque in Pandua, etc.



# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

2

### MANDU / MALWA SCHOOL

**1** The cities of Dhar and Mandu in the Malwa plateau became prominent seats of architecture.

**2** The most prominent feature of the buildings here is the use of different coloured stones and marbles.

**3** The buildings had large windows, which could be as result of European influence and were decorated by a stylised use of arches and pillars.

**4** Even the stairs were used to enhance the aesthetics of the construction.

**5** However, minars were not used in this school of architecture.



# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

2

## MALWA SCHOOL



*Hindola Mahal*

6

The Malwa School of architecture, also known as the Pathan Shool of Architecture is also one of the finest specimens of environmental adaptation of the period because of the following features:

- The **use of large windows** made the buildings and rooms well-ventilated.
- The pavilions were lightly arched which made them airy and allowed the buildings to remain cool in the heat.

# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

2

## MALWA SCHOOL



*Jahaz Mahal*

- 6 The Malwa School of architecture, also known as the **Pathan Shool of Architecture** is also one of the **finest specimens of environmental adaptation** of the period because of the following features (continued...):
- Artificial reservoirs known as '**baulis**' were constructed in the premises for storage of water.

### FURTHER REFERENCE

#### **WATER HERITAGE OF MANDU**

<https://www.downtoearth.org.in/coverage/a-water-harvest-19169>

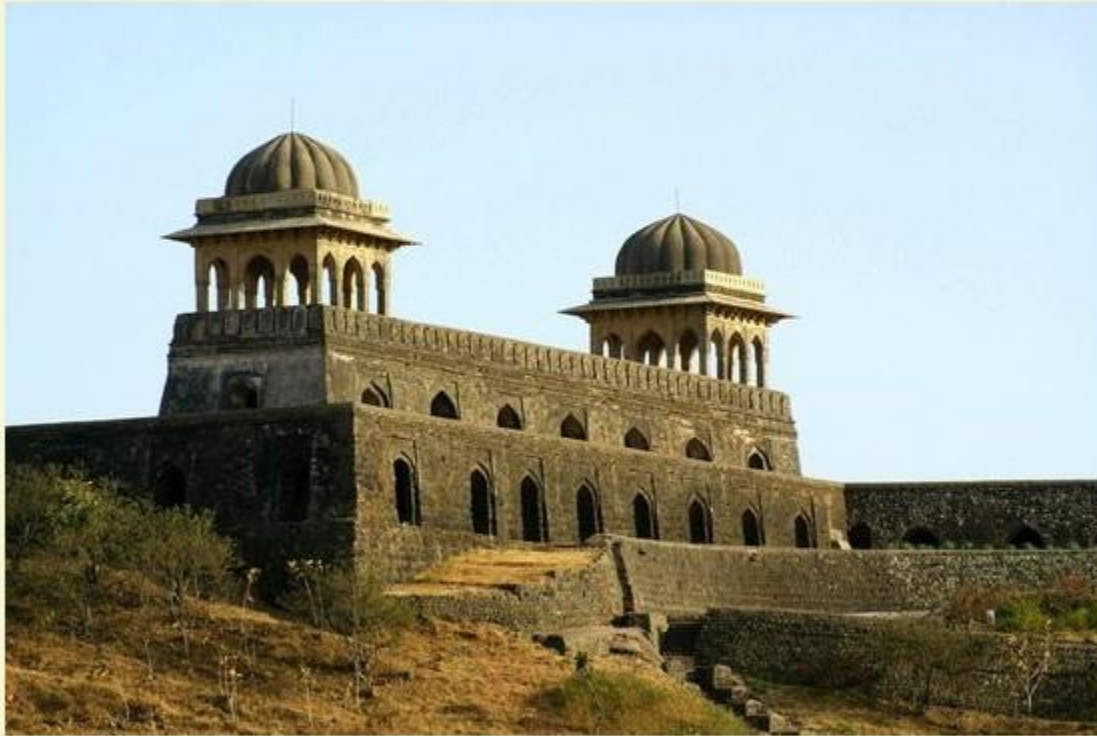


# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

2

## MALWA SCHOOL



*Rani Roopmati Pavillion*

6

The Malwa School of architecture, also known as the Pathan Shool of Architecture is also one of the finest specimens of environmental adaptation of the period because of the following features (continued...):

- Locally available materials were used.
- The **use of battar system** introduced by the Tughlaqs made the buildings strong.

**Example:** Rani Roopmati pavilion, Jahaz Mahal, Ashrafi Mahal etc.

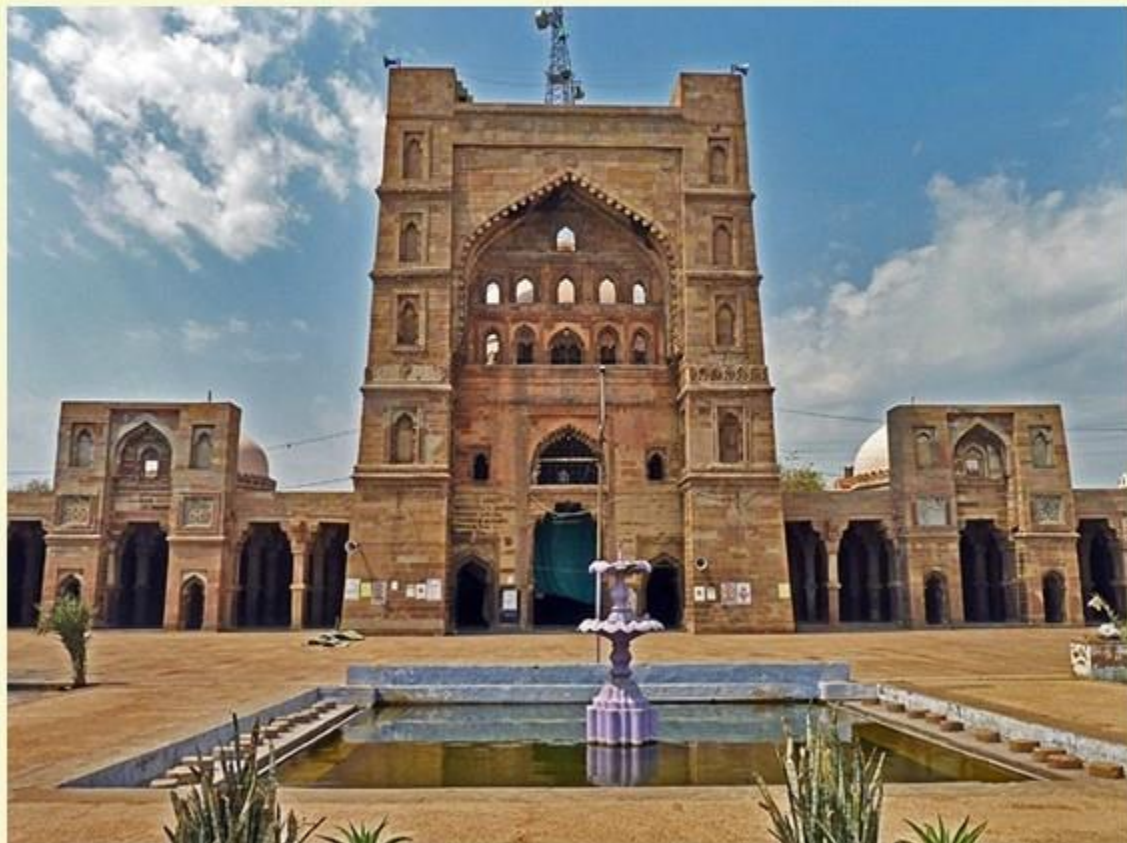


# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

3

## JAUNPUR SCHOOL



*Atala Mosque*

- 1 Patronised by the **Sharqi rulers**, Jaunpur became a centre of great art and cultural activity.
- 2 This style of architecture also came to be known as Sharqi style and also avoided the use of minars as the Pathan style.
- 3 A unique feature of the buildings here is the use of bold and forceful characters painted on huge screens in the centre and side bays of the prayer hall.  
**Example:** Atala Mosque, Jaunpur etc.



# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

4

## GUJARAT SCHOOL



*Jama Masjid at Ahmedabad*

- 1** This school of art developed in the 14<sup>th</sup> century during reign of Khilji dynasty which had placed its governors in Gujarat.
- 2** Jama Masjid at Champaner and Ahmedabad are the most notable contribution of this school.
- 3** Jama Masjid at Ahmedabad is built in yellow sandstone on a large rectangular courtyard. It contains the famous shaking minarets which were partly destroyed in the earthquake.

# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

4

## GUJARAT SCHOOL



*Jama Masjid at Champaner, a UNESCO World Heritage Site*

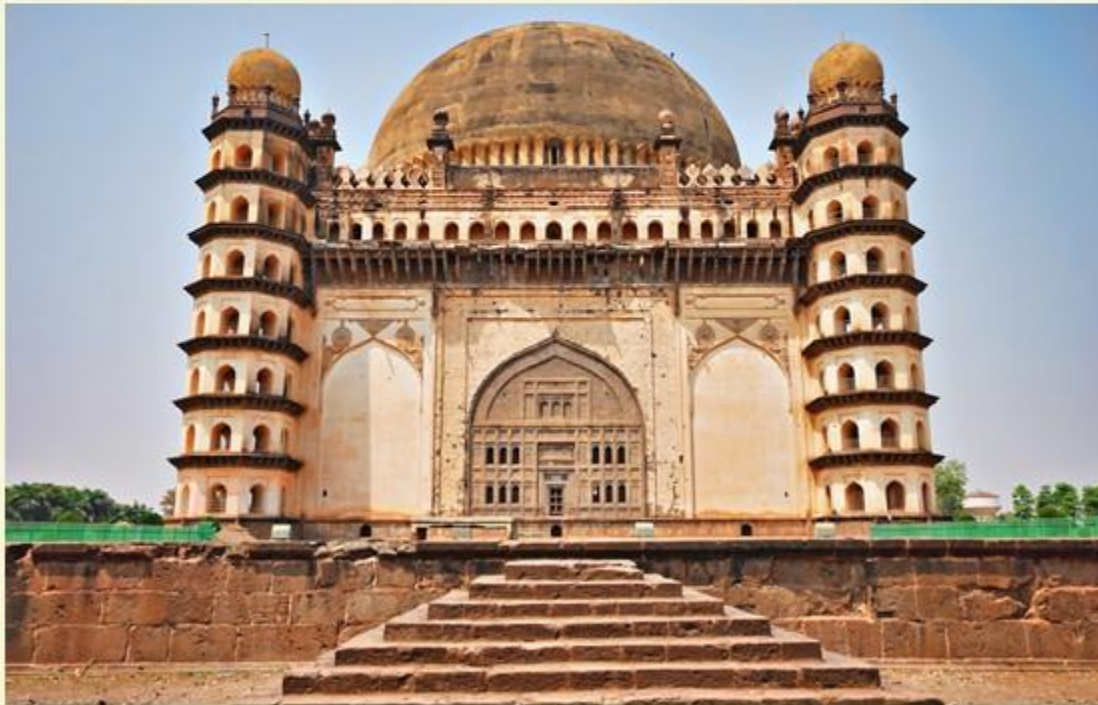


# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

5

## BIJAPUR SCHOOL



**GOL GUMBAZ**

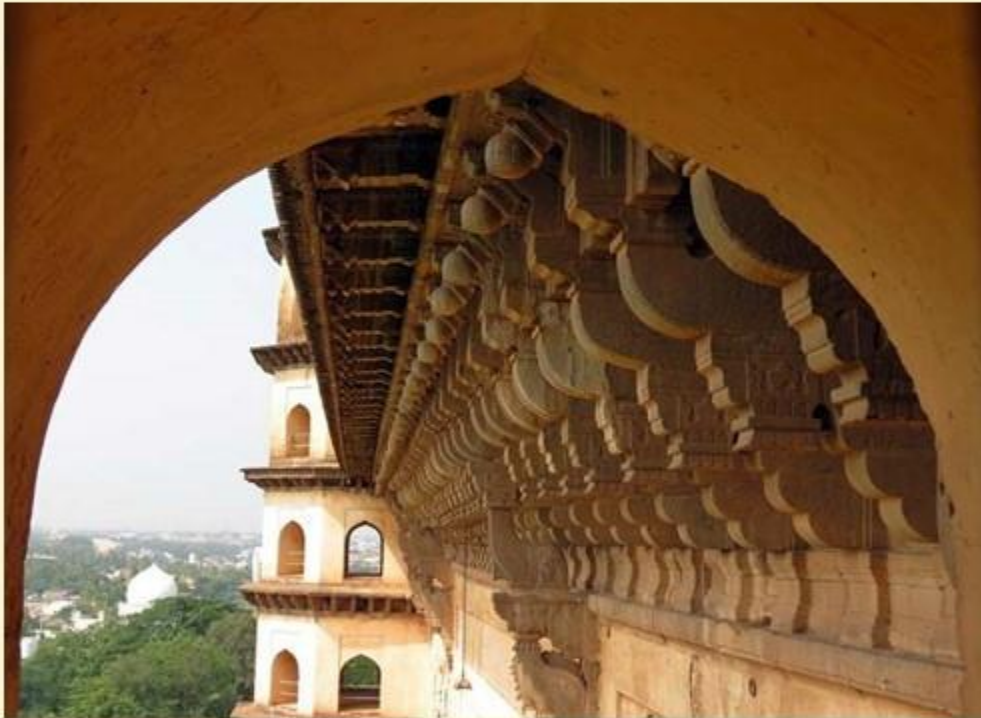
- 1 Under the patronage of Adil Shah, the Bijapur style or the Deccan style of architecture developed.
- 2 He constructed a number of mosques, tombs and palaces which were unique in the use of 3-arched facade and bulbous dome, which were almost spherical and with a narrow neck. He also introduced the use of cornices.

# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

5

## BIJAPUR SCHOOL



*Cornices in Gol Gumbaz*



*Ceiling without any apparent support*

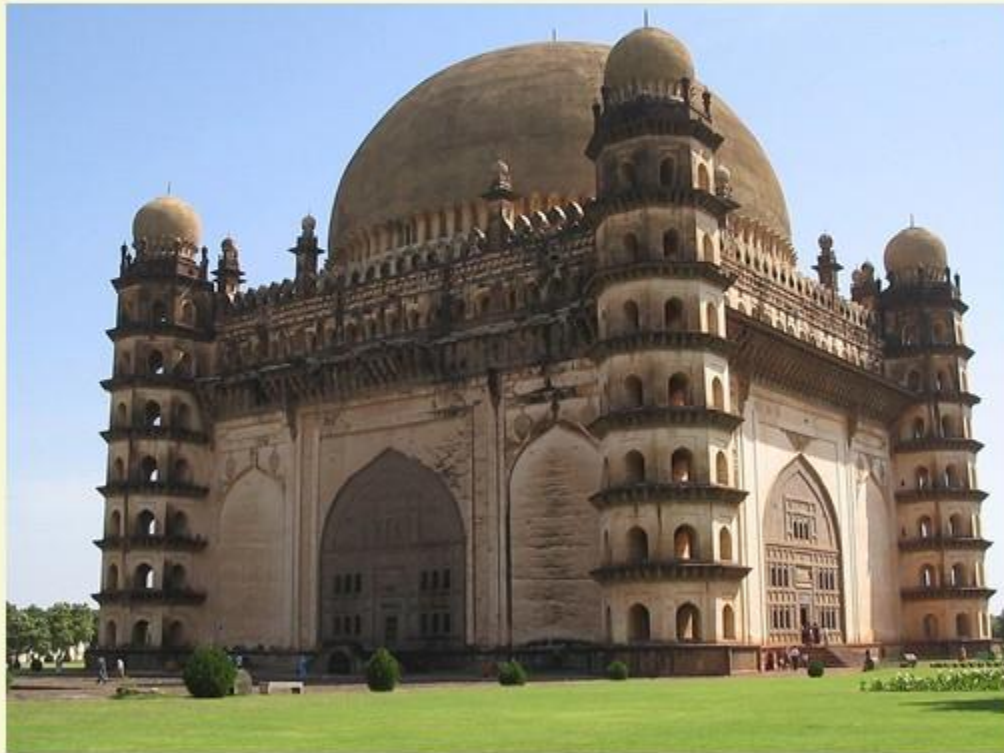


# ARCHITECTURE DURING DELHI SULTANATE PERIOD

## PROVINCIAL STYLE

5

## BIJAPUR SCHOOL



**GOL GUMBAZ**

**3** A special feature of the Bijapur school was the treatment of its ceilings, which were without any apparent support .

**4** Iron clamps and a strong plaster of mortar were used to give strength to the buildings. The walls were decorated by rich carvings.  
**Example:** Gol Gumbaz, the mausoleum of Adil Shah, in Bijapur.

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[suggestions@learningspace.in](mailto:suggestions@learningspace.in)

To Contact us:

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L. V. Krishna  
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